

BI1001 – Skills for Science Scheme Specific Essay (Spring)

For this summative assignment, **students worked individually to produce their own essay and production log**. Students worked with their personal tutor to confirm their essay title and for advice and guidance on this exercise. This assignment builds on the skills learnt and feedback from the Autumn Scheme Specific Essay and production log.

Task and assignment format

This is an individual assignment, and the students use the proforma provided to complete their essay and production log, however within the proforma, the content should follow the following format:

Learning outcomes for scheme specific essay:

- Interpret scientific text.
- Write with clarity and organisation and use language appropriate to the target audience.
- Perform basic computer skills including file management, the use of software applications such as Microsoft Word, PowerPoint, and Excel.
- Summarise the content of written documents.
- Critically evaluate information from a variety of credible sources.
- Demonstrate the effective use of retrieved information, including using evidence to support your statements and arguments.
- Cite references accurately and appropriately and produce a bibliography using a recognised system.
- Use diagrams and graphs appropriately.
- Communicate scientific information via a range of methodologies used in professional scientific practice.

Scheme Specific Essay (SSE) and Production Log Proforma

Part 1: The essay (word guide ~1500 words)

Insert your essay here. Note that the reference list at the end of your essay should contain at least 10 sources, and your citations and the reference list must be formatted in the Cardiff Harvard style.

Part 2: The Production Log (overall word guide ~1000 words)

Q1. Search Strategy:

- i) Identify the types of sources you used for background reading such as textbooks, encyclopedias, web sources, AI tools for example, and for each type, briefly comment on their value, usefulness and any drawbacks. (~150 words)

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- ii) List or tabulate the keywords and terms (including any AI prompts) used for your initial and refined searches (not included in word guide)

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- iii) Using some examples from Q1i and Q1ii to illustrate the process, explain the general strategy you employed to search for the sources in your essay reference list. This might include how you grouped and combined your keywords (using OR/ AND operators), any special techniques you used such as phrase searching, using limits/filters, searching for variant spellings or choosing synonyms, enhanced prompts, to name a few examples. (~400 words)

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Tip: you could include a screenshot(s) of your LibrarySearch advanced search as a supporting figure(s) or create your own tables or flow charts.

Q2. Justification and evaluation of sources:

- i) Select two sources included in your essay reference list but each source must be a different type e.g. book, review article, original article, web site (i.e. do not choose two books for example).

For each source, justify why you selected that source. In your explanation, you should consider why you think that source is credible and relevant, and evaluate the information or content contained within the source.

Source 1: (~150 words)

Source 2: (~150 words)

- ii) Select one source that you identified in your original search strategy which you did NOT include in your essay reference list. Using Cardiff Harvard format, give the full reference of the source below and explain why you did not include this source, commenting on its credibility and authority. (~150 words)

Note: the reference